

Guest Communication in Hospitality

Industry Research Interview

We are conducting independent research on how accommodation providers manage guest communication across channels such as WhatsApp, email, phone, and messaging platforms.

This interview helps us understand real challenges, daily workflows, and unmet needs in the hospitality industry. Your answers are confidential and will only be used for research purposes.

There is nothing to buy. This is not a sales conversation.

Please answer the questions as honestly and specifically as possible. The more detail you provide, the more valuable your input becomes. Filling out this form takes approximately 10-15 minutes.

How to fill out this document:

Click directly into the fields below and type your answers. Check boxes by clicking on them. Save the file when finished and send it back to the person who shared it with you.

A ABOUT YOUR PROPERTY

So we understand who we are speaking with

A1 What type of property do you operate?

- ☐ Hotel ☐ Boutique Hotel ☐ Resort
☐ Vacation Rental / Airbnb ☐ Hostel ☐ Other

A2 How many rooms or units do you manage?

A3 Where is your property located? (city / region / country)

A4 What is your role?

e.g.: Owner, General Manager, Front Desk Manager, Host

A5 How many people work in guest-facing roles at your property?

B COMMUNICATION CHANNELS & VOLUME

Understanding how guests reach you today

B1 Through which channels do guests contact you? (check all that apply)

- ☐ WhatsApp ☐ Email ☐ Phone calls ☐ SMS
☐ Booking.com chat ☐ Airbnb messages ☐ Website chat
☐ Instagram / Facebook DMs ☐ Other:

B2 Which channel creates the most work for you?

B3 Roughly how many guest inquiries do you receive per day?

- ☐ 1-10 ☐ 10-30 ☐ 30-50 ☐ 50+

B4 How much time per day does your team spend responding to guest messages? (estimate in hours)

B5 What percentage of these inquiries would you describe as repetitive -- the same questions asked again and again?

- ☐ Less than 25% ☐ 25-50% ☐ 50-75% ☐ Over 75%

C COMMON GUEST QUESTIONS

What guests ask you most often

C1 What are the top 5 questions guests ask you repeatedly?

Please be specific. e.g. 'What time is check-in?' rather than 'check-in questions'

-
-
-
-
-

C2 Are there questions that are particularly time-consuming to answer, even though they come up often?

D GAPS & PAIN POINTS

Where the real challenges are

D1 What happens when a guest writes to you late at night or on weekends?

- ☐ Someone responds immediately
- ☐ Response comes the next morning
- ☐ Depends on who is available
- ☐ No one responds until the next business day

D2 Has a slow response ever led to a negative review, a lost booking, or a dissatisfied guest? If yes, please describe what happened.

D3 How do you handle guests who write in a language your team does not speak?

D4 During peak season, when inquiry volume doubles or triples, how does your team cope?

D5 On a scale of 1-5, how much of a burden is guest communication on your daily operations?

- ☐ 1 - Not at all ☐ 2 ☐ 3 - Somewhat ☐ 4 ☐ 5 - Very much

D6 If you could eliminate one pain point in guest communication tomorrow, what would it be?

E CURRENT TOOLS & SOLUTIONS

What you have tried or are using today

E1 Are you currently using any tools to help with guest communication?

e.g. chatbots, auto-replies, CRM systems, messaging platforms, PMS with messaging

- ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Tried something, stopped using it

E2 If yes or previously: what worked well and what did not?

F ATTITUDE TOWARD AUTOMATION & AI

Understanding openness and concerns

- F1** If an intelligent system could automatically answer 80% of your repetitive guest questions, in the guest's language, 24/7 -- how useful would that be?
- ☐ 1 - Not at all ☐ 2 ☐ 3 - Somewhat ☐ 4 ☐ 5 - Very much

- F2** What concerns, if any, would you have about using such a system?
e.g. quality of answers, loss of personal touch, data privacy, setup effort, cost

- F3** What would a system like this absolutely NEED to do for you to actually use it?

- F4** What should such a system absolutely NOT do?
Where would automation cause problems?

- F5** How important is it that the system can seamlessly hand off to a human team member when needed?

☐ 1 - Not at all ☐ 2 ☐ 3 - Somewhat ☐ 4 ☐ 5 - Very much

G BUDGET & DECISION-MAKING

Understanding willingness to invest

- G1** Roughly what does guest communication cost you today, including staff time? (monthly estimate)

Even a rough estimate is helpful. e.g. '\$500/month in staff time' or '1 full-time person'

- G2** If a solution saved your team 2-3 hours per day on guest messages, what would that be worth to you per month?

☐ Under \$50 ☐ \$50-100 ☐ \$100-250 ☐ Over \$250

- G3** Who makes the decision about new tools at your property?

☐ I decide myself ☐ I decide with a partner ☐ Someone else decides

H FEATURE PRIORITIES

Which capabilities matter most to you

H1 If a guest communication tool existed, which features would matter most?

Rate each: 1 = not important, 5 = essential

Automatic replies to common questions (FAQ)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Multilingual support (respond in the guest's language)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Available 24/7 including nights and weekends	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Seamless handoff to a human when needed	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Works on WhatsApp	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Works on email	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Works on website chat	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Integration with booking/PMS system	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Pre-arrival messages sent automatically	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Post-stay follow-up and review requests	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Complaint detection and escalation	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Local recommendations (restaurants, activities)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

1 2 3 4 5

H2 Is there a feature not listed above that you would consider essential?

I CLOSING

Final thoughts and next steps

I1 Is there anything else about guest communication that we should know?

I2 Would you be open to a brief follow-up conversation (10 min) to discuss your answers in more detail?

☐ Yes

☐ Maybe later

☐ No, thank you

I3 If yes, how can we best reach you?

Name:

Email:

WhatsApp:

Thank you for your time.

Your answers are incredibly valuable and will directly shape how we approach the challenges in guest communication.

Please save this file and send it back to the person who shared it with you.